Jack Sturtevant
jack@sturt.io

Hi,

Thanks for the invite. I'm a hands-on engineer who has spent most of the last seven years as the lead engineer on small teams. That has meant turning what a founder or client wants into a plan, splitting it into tasks, and keeping the work on track. This role is that same job with the coordination as the main focus.

Background: I've been a professional software engineer since 2019. I started at AWS and Applied Intuition. Since then I've been a two-time founder/CTO and a contract lead engineer, usually as the first or most senior engineer.

Coordinating teams and clients:

- Lancer (founder/CTO): I led a 7-person team building a freelance marketplace with escrowed payments, from planning through launch. 55 clients funded 264 jobs on it, and we won $30K at Solana's Grizzlython.
- Ralli (founder/CTO): I led the engineering team on a real-time social sports betting app (Next.js, NestJS, Postgres, WebSockets) and scaled us from part-time to full-time.
- Banger (interim CTO): I took the founders' idea to a working trading platform in eight weeks. I worked directly with them on scope. The product led directly to a $250K raise.
- Coordinator (lead engineer, contract, 2026): I led engineering on the client's AI platform: LLM fine-tuning and serving, voice and video pipelines, CI/CD, and an API gateway for third-party apps.
- Applied Intuition: I built the internal tool the company used to manage developers, teams and customers. I also built a support system that cut customer response time from over a day to under an hour.

Technologies: TypeScript, React/Next.js and Node (NestJS, tRPC) on the web, Python for AI and data work, Go, Postgres, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS and GCP. I work hands-on with LLM integrations, RAG, and workflow automation. I also used Java earlier in my career, though not recently.

My approach:

1. Requirements: I turn each request into a short written spec covering the goal, what's in and out of scope, acceptance criteria, and open questions. The client confirms it before any work starts, which catches most misunderstandings early.
2. Tasks and priorities: I break the spec into tasks a developer can finish in a day or two. Then I order them by risk and value, so the riskiest and most important work happens first.
3. Technical review: I read the code and the designs, so I can spot implementation problems and blockers early instead of finding out at the deadline.
4. Timelines: each milestone has a target date and a weekly written update covering what shipped, what's next, and what's at risk. If a date slips, the client hears it early, along with options such as cutting scope or moving the date.

Availability and rate: I'm available now, part-time, and can scale up to 30+ hours a week. My rate is [RATE]/hr.

A few questions so I can understand the setup:

1. How many developers would I be coordinating, and are they in-house or contractors?
2. Will I be talking to clients directly on your Upwork account, or through my own?
3. What project-management tools do you use today (Jira, Linear, Trello, GitHub)?

Happy to get on a call.

Jack Sturtevant